

SIMATS ENGINEERING

Short Answer Test

COURSE NAME: Software Testing

COURSE CODE: CSA37

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

CO1: *Apply software testing principles to enhance the effectiveness of software quality assurance and improve defect detection strategies.*

Assessment Tool Weightage: 30%

Sl. No	Questions	Bloom's Level
1	A startup team relies on random testing methods, leading to inconsistent results and missed defects. The project manager wants to improve testing effectiveness. As a test engineer, apply the concept of testing as an engineering activity to redesign the approach. Explain how structured test design improves quality and defect detection.	3
2	A banking system undergoes multiple failures due to lack of a defined testing process. The organization plans to standardize its testing activities. Illustrate how a well-defined testing process improves software quality in such real-time systems. Explain the benefits with relevant examples.	3
3	During development of an e-commerce platform, testing activities are performed inconsistently across phases. This leads to integration and system-level defects. Demonstrate how testing should be carried out as a structured process in SDLC. Explain how process discipline ensures better quality outcomes.	3
4	A login system shows mismatch between expected and actual outputs during validation. The development team is unsure whether the issue is an error, defect, or failure. Apply basic testing definitions to classify the issue. Explain the relationship between these terms with suitable examples.	3
5	A team struggles to detect defects early, leading to increased cost during later stages. The manager wants to improve defect detection efficiency. Apply a software testing principle to address this issue. Explain how the principle improves testing effectiveness with an example.	3
6	During requirement analysis of a healthcare system, several ambiguities go unnoticed. Later, these lead to defects in implementation. Show how a tester can contribute during the requirement phase to improve quality. Explain the importance of early testing involvement.	3
7	A payroll system produces incorrect outputs due to unclear and ambiguous requirements. The development team needs to identify the origin of defects. Analyze how such defects originate in the software lifecycle. Explain how requirement clarity can prevent such issues.	3

8	A system crashes when boundary input values are entered by users. The team suspects improper testing coverage. Classify this defect and justify your answer. Explain how boundary value analysis could have prevented this issue.	3
9	A company maintains a defect repository but rarely uses it for improving testing practices. This results in repeated defects across releases. Demonstrate how a defect repository can support better test case design. Explain its role in improving software quality.	3
10	An ATM system fails during withdrawal due to incorrect handling of transaction logic. The issue was not detected during testing. Apply your testing knowledge to identify and describe this as a functional defect. Explain how it could have been prevented.	3
11	A large application shows that most defects are concentrated in a few modules. The testing team wants to optimize their efforts. Use the concept of defect clustering to identify testing priorities. Explain how this improves testing efficiency.	3
12	A web application experiences slow performance under heavy user load. The issue needs to be categorized properly. Apply defect classification techniques to identify this type of defect. Explain how classification helps in better resolution.	3
13	A team is preparing for regression testing after multiple releases. They have access to historical defect data. Show how this data can be reused effectively for regression testing. Explain how it improves test coverage and efficiency.	3
14	During integration testing, multiple defects are found due to poor communication between developers and testers. The organization wants to improve collaboration. Identify the role of a tester in minimizing such defects. Explain how early involvement helps.	3
15	A software product repeatedly faces similar defects in every release cycle. The team needs a long-term solution. Apply defect prevention techniques to address recurring issues. Explain how prevention improves overall software quality.	3
16	A mobile application frequently crashes due to inconsistent testing approaches. The testing team wants to standardize practices. Apply testing principles to redesign the testing strategy. Explain how structured approaches improve reliability.	3
17	A company confuses debugging with testing, leading to delays in defect resolution. The team needs clarity on both concepts. Differentiate testing and debugging using a real-time scenario. Explain their roles in improving software quality.	3
18	An online shopping system behaves differently across browsers. This leads to customer dissatisfaction. Apply testing principles to design a cross-browser testing strategy. Explain how such issues can be effectively handled.	3

19	A logistics application produces inconsistent outputs due to improper validation. The issue is not detected early. Apply testing concepts to identify gaps in validation. Explain how proper testing improves system reliability.	3
20	A team skips structured test case design and directly executes random tests. This leads to poor defect detection. Apply testing as an engineering activity to improve the process. Explain the importance of systematic test design.	3
21	A healthcare system shows data inconsistency between modules due to integration issues. The testing team needs to analyze the problem. Apply testing principles to identify root causes. Explain how proper testing ensures data consistency.	3
22	A project experiences delays because testers are not involved early in development. The organization wants to improve collaboration. Explain the role of testers across SDLC phases. Show how early involvement improves quality.	3
23	A system fails during peak usage due to untested scenarios. The testing team missed critical cases. Apply testing principles to identify gaps. Explain how better test coverage prevents such failures.	3
24	A software team lacks proper defect documentation, making tracking difficult. The organization wants to improve defect management. Apply defect repository concepts to solve this issue. Explain how documentation enhances tracking and analysis.	3
25	A banking system produces repeated transaction failures due to improper testing practices. The team needs to improve quality. Apply software testing principles to redesign the testing approach. Explain how structured testing enhances reliability.	3
26	A system shows failures due to missing edge case testing. The testers focused only on normal inputs. Apply testing principles to include edge cases. Explain how boundary testing improves defect detection.	3
27	A development team struggles to maintain consistency in testing across modules. This leads to uneven quality. Apply process-based testing approaches to address this issue. Explain how standardization improves outcomes.	3
28	A web application fails due to improper handling of unexpected inputs. The testing team missed validation scenarios. Apply testing concepts to improve input validation. Explain how proper testing ensures robustness.	3
29	A software company faces frequent defect leakage into production. The management wants to reduce such issues. Apply testing principles to analyze the root cause. Explain how improved testing practices prevent leakage.	3
30	A project team is unable to identify defects early due to poor testing strategies. This increases overall cost and effort. Apply testing principles to redesign the strategy. Explain how early defect detection improves efficiency.	3



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RUBRICS FOR CALCULATION:

Criteria	Weightage	Level 4 – Exemplary (5 Marks)	Level 3 – Proficient (4 Marks)	Level 2 – Developing (2–3 Marks)	Level 1 – Beginning (0–1 Mark)
Conceptual Understanding	30	Demonstrates clear and complete understanding of the concept	Good understanding with minor gaps	Basic understanding with some misconceptions	Poor or incorrect understanding
Accuracy of Answer	25	Completely correct answer with no errors	Mostly correct with minor errors	Partially correct with noticeable errors	Incorrect or irrelevant answer
Application of Knowledge	20	Correctly applies concepts to solve the question/problem	Applies concepts with minor mistakes	Limited or partially correct application	No or incorrect application
Completeness of Response	15	Covers all required parts of the question	Covers most parts with minor omissions	Covers only some parts	Incomplete or missing response
Clarity & Presentation	10	Clear, concise, and well-organized answer	Understandable with minor issues	Somewhat unclear or poorly structured	Difficult to understand

Answers:

1. Question

A startup team relies on random testing methods, leading to inconsistent results and missed defects. The project manager wants to improve testing effectiveness. As a test engineer, apply the concept of testing as an engineering activity to redesign the approach. Explain how structured test design improves quality and defect detection.

Answer

Testing should be treated as a systematic engineering activity rather than random execution. The startup should begin by understanding requirements and identifying test conditions. Test cases should then be designed using techniques such as **equivalence partitioning, boundary value analysis, decision table testing, and state transition testing.**

A structured approach can include:

- Requirement analysis and traceability.
- Preparation of a formal test plan.
- Systematic test case design.
- Test data preparation.
- Automated execution where suitable.
- Defect logging and tracking.
- Regression testing after defect fixes.

For example, if an application accepts an age between 18 and 60, boundary testing should check 17, 18, 19, 59, 60, and 61 instead of testing random values.

Thus, structured test design provides better coverage, reduces missed defects, produces repeatable results, and improves overall software quality.

2. Question

A banking system undergoes multiple failures due to lack of a defined testing process. The organization plans to standardize its testing activities. Illustrate how a well-defined testing process improves software quality in such real-time systems. Explain the benefits with relevant examples.

Answer

A well-defined testing process provides a systematic sequence of activities from requirement analysis to final validation. In a banking system, testing should begin with requirement analysis and continue through unit, integration, system, security, performance, and acceptance testing.

A standard process can include:

1. Requirement review.
2. Test planning.
3. Test case design.
4. Test environment and data preparation.
5. Test execution.
6. Defect reporting and retesting.
7. Regression testing.
8. Test closure.

For example, during an online fund transfer, testers should verify valid transfers, insufficient balance, invalid account numbers, transaction limits, network interruptions, and duplicate transactions.

Standardization ensures that important scenarios are not missed and that every release follows consistent quality checks. It also improves traceability, defect detection, reliability, and customer confidence.

3. Question

During development of an e-commerce platform, testing activities are performed inconsistently across phases. This leads to integration and system-level defects. Demonstrate how testing should be carried out as a structured process in SDLC. Explain how process discipline ensures better quality outcomes.

Answer

Testing should be integrated throughout the **Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC)** rather than being performed only after coding.

A structured approach is:

- **Requirement phase:** Testers review requirements for ambiguity and missing conditions.
- **Design phase:** Testers identify integration points and prepare test scenarios.
- **Development phase:** Unit testing is performed by developers.
- **Integration phase:** Interactions between modules such as cart, payment, and inventory are tested.
- **System testing:** The complete e-commerce application is tested.
- **Acceptance testing:** Business requirements are validated.
- **Maintenance:** Regression testing is performed after changes.

For example, when a customer purchases a product, the system must correctly update the cart, payment status, inventory, and order history.

Process discipline ensures consistent testing, early defect detection, better traceability, and fewer integration defects reaching production.

4. Question

A login system shows mismatch between expected and actual outputs during validation. The development team is unsure whether the issue is an error, defect, or failure. Apply basic testing definitions to classify the issue. Explain the relationship between these terms with suitable examples.

Answer

The terms **error**, **defect**, and **failure** represent different stages of a problem.

- **Error:** A human mistake made during requirements, design, or coding.
- **Defect:** A flaw introduced into the software because of an error.
- **Failure:** The observable incorrect behavior when the software executes the defective code.

For example, suppose a developer misunderstands the login requirement and writes code that accepts an incorrect password.

The sequence is:

Human mistake → Error → Defect in software → Execution → Failure

If the expected result is successful login only with valid credentials, but the system accepts an incorrect password, the incorrect behavior is a failure caused by a defect.

Understanding these terms improves defect reporting because testers can clearly describe the observed failure and provide information that helps developers identify the underlying defect.

5. Question

A team struggles to detect defects early, leading to increased cost during later stages. The manager wants to improve defect detection efficiency. Apply a software testing principle to address this issue. Explain how the principle improves testing effectiveness with an example.

Answer

The most suitable principle is “**Early testing saves time and cost.**” Testing activities should begin as early as possible in the SDLC.

Testers can participate during requirement and design reviews to identify ambiguity, missing requirements, incorrect assumptions, and inconsistent business rules before implementation.

For example, suppose a banking requirement states that a customer can transfer money up to a certain daily limit but does not clearly define whether failed transactions count toward the limit. Identifying this ambiguity during requirements review is much cheaper than discovering it after deployment.

Early testing improves effectiveness by:

- Detecting defects before they propagate.
- Reducing rework.
- Lowering correction cost.
- Improving requirement quality.
- Preventing downstream defects.

Therefore, involving testers early and applying reviews, static analysis, and early test design can significantly improve defect detection efficiency.

6. Question

During requirement analysis of a healthcare system, several ambiguities go unnoticed. Later, these lead to defects in implementation. Show how a tester can contribute during the requirement phase to improve quality. Explain the importance of early testing involvement.

Answer

A tester can contribute during requirement analysis by reviewing requirements for **clarity, completeness, consistency, testability, and correctness**.

The tester should:

- Identify ambiguous statements.
- Ask questions about missing conditions.
- Identify boundary conditions.
- Check whether requirements are measurable and testable.
- Prepare initial test scenarios.
- Create requirement traceability links.

For example, if a healthcare system requirement states that “patient records should be retained for a suitable period,” the term “suitable period” is ambiguous. The tester should ask for a specific retention period and applicable conditions.

Early involvement prevents misunderstandings from becoming design and coding defects. It also reduces rework and development cost.

Thus, tester participation during requirements improves quality by ensuring that requirements are clear, complete, consistent, and testable before implementation begins.

7. Question

A payroll system produces incorrect outputs due to unclear and ambiguous requirements. The development team needs to identify the origin of defects. Analyze how such defects originate in the software lifecycle. Explain how requirement clarity can prevent such issues.

Answer

Defects can originate at different stages of the SDLC. In this case, the primary source is the **requirements phase**.

The defect flow may be:

Ambiguous requirement → Incorrect interpretation → Incorrect design → Incorrect implementation → Incorrect output

For example, a payroll requirement may state that overtime should be calculated according to company rules without specifying whether overtime is calculated hourly, daily, or monthly.

The developer may implement an incorrect interpretation, causing wrong salary calculations.

Requirement clarity can prevent this by:

- Using precise and measurable statements.
- Defining business rules clearly.
- Specifying inputs and expected outputs.
- Documenting exceptional conditions.
- Conducting requirement reviews.
- Involving testers and stakeholders early.

Clear requirements reduce misunderstanding and provide a reliable basis for test case design. Therefore, improving requirement quality can prevent defects before coding begins.

8. Question

A system crashes when boundary input values are entered by users. The team suspects improper testing coverage. Classify this defect and justify your answer. Explain how boundary value analysis could have prevented this issue.

Answer

This is primarily a **functional/input validation defect** because the system does not correctly handle valid or invalid boundary inputs.

Boundary-related defects commonly occur because developers may handle normal values correctly but fail at minimum or maximum limits.

For example, if a system accepts values from **1 to 100**, test cases should include:

- 0 – below minimum
- 1 – minimum
- 2 – just above minimum
- 99 – just below maximum
- 100 – maximum
- 101 – above maximum

This technique is called **Boundary Value Analysis (BVA)**.

If the system crashes at 100 or 101, BVA would likely reveal the problem before release.

Therefore, proper boundary testing improves test coverage by specifically targeting values where defects are more likely to occur and prevents unexpected system failures.

9. Question

A company maintains a defect repository but rarely uses it for improving testing practices. This results in repeated defects across releases. Demonstrate how a defect repository can support better test case design. Explain its role in improving software quality.

Answer

A **defect repository** stores information about previously identified defects, including their causes, affected modules, severity, priority, detection phase, and resolution.

Testers can analyze historical defects to identify recurring patterns and improve test cases.

For example, if previous releases repeatedly contained payment calculation defects, testers can create additional test cases for:

- Different payment methods.
- Boundary transaction amounts.
- Failed transactions.
- Duplicate payments.
- Currency or rounding conditions.

The repository can support:

- Risk-based test planning.
- Regression test selection.
- Identification of defect-prone modules.
- Test case improvement.
- Defect prevention.
- Root-cause analysis.

Therefore, the defect repository should not be treated merely as a record-keeping system. Historical defect information should actively influence future testing and help prevent repeated defects.

10. Question

An ATM system fails during withdrawal due to incorrect handling of transaction logic. The issue was not detected during testing. Apply your testing knowledge to identify and describe this as a functional defect. Explain how it could have been prevented.

Answer

This is a **functional defect** because the ATM is not performing the withdrawal operation according to its specified business requirements.

For example, an ATM may deduct ₹5,000 from the customer's account even though the machine dispenses only ₹4,000. This indicates incorrect transaction logic.

The defect could have been prevented through systematic functional testing such as:

- Valid withdrawal testing.
- Insufficient balance testing.
- Daily withdrawal limit testing.
- Invalid amount testing.
- Cash availability testing.
- Transaction cancellation testing.
- Network interruption testing.
- Account balance verification.

Testers should also perform integration testing between the ATM, banking server, and account database.

Proper test case design and transaction-level validation would have detected the incorrect logic before deployment, improving reliability and preventing financial inconsistencies.

11. Question

A large application shows that most defects are concentrated in a few modules. The testing team wants to optimize their efforts. Use the concept of defect clustering to identify testing priorities. Explain how this improves testing efficiency.

Answer

Defect clustering is the principle that a small number of modules often contain a large proportion of defects.

The testing team should analyze historical defect data and identify modules with high defect concentration. These modules should receive higher testing priority.

For example, if an application has 20 modules but 70% of previous defects occurred in the payment, authentication, and reporting modules, these areas should receive more intensive testing.

Testing priorities can include:

1. High-defect modules – highest priority.
2. Business-critical modules – high priority.
3. Frequently modified modules – high priority.
4. Stable, low-risk modules – comparatively lower priority.

This approach allows limited testing resources to be used where they provide maximum benefit. It improves defect detection efficiency and reduces the risk of critical defects escaping into production.

12. Question

A web application experiences slow performance under heavy user load. The issue needs to be categorized properly. Apply defect classification techniques to identify this type of defect. Explain how classification helps in better resolution.

Answer

The problem is primarily a **performance defect**, specifically related to the application's behavior under high load.

A performance defect occurs when the system does not meet specified response-time, throughput, scalability, or resource-utilization requirements.

For example, an online shopping website may respond within 2 seconds for 100 users but take 15 seconds when 5,000 users access it simultaneously.

Testing should include:

- Load testing.
- Stress testing.
- Endurance testing.
- Response-time measurement.
- Resource utilization monitoring.
- Database performance analysis.

Correct classification helps assign the defect to the appropriate technical area. Developers can then investigate causes such as inefficient database queries, insufficient server resources, memory usage, or poor application design.

Thus, proper defect classification improves diagnosis, prioritization, and resolution efficiency.

13. Question

A team is preparing for regression testing after multiple releases. They have access to historical defect data. Show how this data can be reused effectively for regression testing. Explain how it improves test coverage and efficiency.

Answer

Historical defect data can be reused to identify areas that are likely to contain defects after new changes.

The team should analyze:

- Previously defective modules.
- Frequently recurring defects.
- Defects caused by code changes.
- High-severity defects.
- Defect-prone functionalities.

For example, if previous releases repeatedly contained defects in payment processing, those test cases should become an important part of the regression suite.

A regression suite can contain:

1. Critical business functionality tests.
2. Previously failed test cases.
3. Tests related to modified modules.
4. Tests covering dependent modules.
5. High-risk boundary and integration scenarios.

Reusing historical information prevents testers from repeating the same analysis from scratch. It increases coverage of high-risk areas while reducing unnecessary testing effort.

Therefore, defect history acts as valuable input for efficient regression test planning.

14. Question

During integration testing, multiple defects are found due to poor communication between developers and testers. The organization wants to improve collaboration. Identify the role of a tester in minimizing such defects. Explain how early involvement helps.

Answer

A tester plays an important role not only in executing test cases but also in improving communication and quality throughout the SDLC.

The tester should:

- Participate in requirement discussions.
- Review designs.
- Clarify acceptance criteria.
- Identify integration risks.
- Communicate defects clearly.
- Work closely with developers.
- Participate in defect triage and root-cause analysis.

For example, in an e-commerce application, the tester can discuss with developers how the payment module should communicate with the order and inventory modules before integration begins.

Early involvement helps identify misunderstandings before coding and integration. It reduces rework, improves requirements, strengthens collaboration, and prevents integration defects.

Thus, testers act as quality stakeholders throughout development rather than only as final-stage defect finders.

15. Question

A software product repeatedly faces similar defects in every release cycle. The team needs a long-term solution. Apply defect prevention techniques to address recurring issues. Explain how prevention improves overall software quality.

Answer

Recurring defects indicate that the organization is fixing symptoms without addressing their underlying causes. **Defect prevention** focuses on eliminating the causes of defects before they recur.

The team should:

1. Perform root-cause analysis.
2. Identify common defect patterns.
3. Review development and testing processes.
4. Improve coding and design standards.
5. Strengthen requirement reviews.
6. Add regression test cases.
7. Conduct peer reviews.
8. Provide training where necessary.

For example, if incorrect date calculations repeatedly occur, the team should identify why developers are making the same mistake and establish a standard date-handling method along with dedicated test cases.

Prevention reduces repeated defects, maintenance effort, testing cost, and production failures. It creates continuous process improvement and results in more stable and reliable software.

16. Question

A mobile application frequently crashes due to inconsistent testing approaches. The testing team wants to standardize practices. Apply testing principles to redesign the testing strategy. Explain how structured approaches improve reliability.

Answer

The team should replace inconsistent testing with a standardized and risk-based testing strategy.

The redesigned approach should include:

- Requirement-based test planning.
- Standard test case templates.
- Functional testing.
- Compatibility testing across devices and operating systems.
- Performance testing.
- Negative and boundary testing.
- Automated regression testing.
- Defect tracking and reporting.

For example, a mobile banking application should be tested on different screen sizes, operating systems, network conditions, memory conditions, and user actions such as repeated taps or interrupted transactions.

Standardization ensures that every tester follows common procedures and that important scenarios are not missed.

A structured approach produces repeatable results, improves test coverage, identifies crash conditions earlier, and increases application reliability.

17. Question

A company confuses debugging with testing, leading to delays in defect resolution. The team needs clarity on both concepts. Differentiate testing and debugging using a real-time scenario. Explain their roles in improving software quality.

Answer

Testing and debugging are related but different activities.

Testing	Debugging
Identifies failures or defects	Finds and fixes the cause of a defect
Usually performed by testers and developers	Primarily performed by developers
Determines whether software behaves as expected	Determines why the software behaves incorrectly
Produces defect reports	Produces code corrections

For example, during ATM testing, a tester discovers that ₹5,000 is deducted but only ₹4,000 is dispensed. This is **testing** because the tester has identified an unexpected behavior.

The developer then examines the transaction logic, finds the incorrect cash calculation, and modifies the code. This is **debugging**.

Testing verifies the quality of the product, while debugging removes the underlying cause of identified problems. Both are necessary for effective software quality improvement.

18. Question

An online shopping system behaves differently across browsers. This leads to customer dissatisfaction. Apply testing principles to design a cross-browser testing strategy. Explain how such issues can be effectively handled.

Answer

The problem can be addressed using **cross-browser compatibility testing**.

The testing strategy should include:

- Identify supported browsers.
- Test different browser versions where required.
- Test desktop and mobile environments.
- Verify UI layout and functionality.
- Test JavaScript behavior.
- Validate forms and transactions.
- Perform regression testing after fixes.

For example, the checkout page should be tested on commonly supported browsers such as Chrome, Edge, Firefox, and Safari. Testers should verify login, product search, cart operations, payment, and order confirmation.

Defects should be recorded with browser name, version, operating system, steps to reproduce, screenshots, and expected versus actual results.

Systematic compatibility testing ensures consistent user experience and prevents browser-specific failures from reaching customers.

19. Question

A logistics application produces inconsistent outputs due to improper validation. The issue is not detected early. Apply testing concepts to identify gaps in validation. Explain how proper testing improves system reliability.

Answer

The issue indicates inadequate **input and functional validation testing**.

The tester should identify whether the application correctly validates:

- Valid inputs.
- Invalid inputs.
- Missing values.
- Boundary values.
- Incorrect data formats.
- Duplicate values.
- Unexpected inputs.

For example, if a logistics application accepts package weight between 1 kg and 100 kg, testing should include values such as 0, 1, 2, 99, 100, and 101 kg.

Testers should also verify whether the same input produces consistent results across modules.

Proper validation testing detects incorrect assumptions and prevents invalid data from entering the system. It improves reliability by ensuring that inputs are correctly processed and outputs conform to requirements.

Therefore, systematic validation and boundary testing should be included in the test strategy.

20. Question

A team skips structured test case design and directly executes random tests. This leads to poor defect detection. Apply testing as an engineering activity to improve the process. Explain the importance of systematic test design.

Answer

Testing should be performed as an engineering activity using planned and systematic test design instead of random execution.

The team should:

1. Analyze requirements.
2. Identify test conditions.
3. Select suitable testing techniques.
4. Design test cases.
5. Prepare test data.
6. Execute tests.
7. Record results.
8. Report defects.
9. Perform regression testing.

Techniques such as **equivalence partitioning, boundary value analysis, decision tables, and state transition testing** help cover different types of conditions.

For example, if an application accepts marks from 0 to 100, testing only random values such as 45 and 70 may miss important boundary defects. Values such as -1, 0, 1, 99, 100, and 101 provide better coverage.

Systematic design improves repeatability, coverage, defect detection, and overall software quality.

21. Question

A healthcare system shows data inconsistency between modules due to integration issues. The testing team needs to analyze the problem. Apply testing principles to identify root causes. Explain how proper testing ensures data consistency.

Answer

The problem should be investigated through **integration testing and data consistency validation**.

The tester should identify how data moves between modules such as patient registration, appointment management, billing, and medical records.

Possible root causes include:

- Incorrect data mapping.
- Interface defects.
- Database synchronization problems.
- Incorrect API responses.
- Data format mismatches.
- Transaction failures.

For example, if a patient's updated address appears correctly in the registration module but incorrectly in billing, the tester should trace the data flow between these modules.

Testing should verify that data entered in one module is correctly transmitted, stored, retrieved, and displayed in dependent modules.

Proper integration testing, API testing, database validation, and end-to-end testing help maintain data consistency and improve system reliability.

22. Question

A project experiences delays because testers are not involved early in development. The organization wants to improve collaboration. Explain the role of testers across SDLC phases. Show how early involvement improves quality.

Answer

Testers should participate throughout the SDLC instead of joining only after development is completed.

Their role includes:

- **Requirement phase:** Review requirements for clarity and testability.
- **Design phase:** Identify risks and integration points.
- **Development phase:** Prepare test scenarios and support early testing.
- **Integration phase:** Validate interactions between modules.
- **System testing:** Verify complete system behavior.
- **Acceptance testing:** Validate business requirements.
- **Maintenance:** Perform regression testing after changes.

For example, if testers identify an ambiguous payment requirement during the requirement phase, developers can clarify it before implementation.

Early involvement prevents requirement misunderstandings from becoming expensive defects. It also improves communication between developers, testers, and business stakeholders.

Therefore, involving testers throughout the SDLC improves quality, reduces rework, and supports faster defect detection.

23. Question

A system fails during peak usage due to untested scenarios. The testing team missed critical cases. Apply testing principles to identify gaps. Explain how better test coverage prevents such failures.

Answer

The failure indicates insufficient **test coverage**, particularly in performance and high-load scenarios.

The team should identify missing scenarios such as:

- Maximum concurrent users.
- High transaction volume.
- Long-duration usage.
- Peak database activity.
- Limited server resources.
- Network congestion.
- Multiple users accessing the same functionality simultaneously.

For example, an online learning platform may work correctly with 100 users but fail when 10,000 students access it simultaneously during an examination.

Load testing, stress testing, endurance testing, and performance monitoring should be included in the test plan.

Better coverage ensures that important real-world operating conditions are tested before deployment. This helps identify scalability and performance defects early and improves system reliability during peak usage.

24. Question

A software team lacks proper defect documentation, making tracking difficult. The organization wants to improve defect management. Apply defect repository concepts to solve this issue. Explain how documentation enhances tracking and analysis.

Answer

The organization should establish a structured **defect repository** containing complete and standardized defect information.

Each defect record should include:

- Unique defect ID.
- Defect title.
- Description.
- Module affected.
- Steps to reproduce.
- Expected result.
- Actual result.
- Severity.
- Priority.
- Environment.
- Screenshots or logs.
- Assigned person.
- Status.
- Resolution details.

For example, instead of reporting “login is not working,” the tester should specify the exact steps, credentials or test conditions, expected behavior, actual behavior, and environment.

Proper documentation makes defects easier to reproduce, prioritize, assign, track, and analyze.

Historical defect records can also reveal recurring problem areas and support regression testing and defect prevention. Therefore, a structured repository improves both defect management and long-term software quality.

25. Question

A banking system produces repeated transaction failures due to improper testing practices. The team needs to improve quality. Apply software testing principles to redesign the testing approach. Explain how structured testing enhances reliability.

Answer

The banking system requires a structured, risk-based testing strategy because transaction processing is business-critical.

The redesigned approach should include:

- Requirement and business-rule review.
- Functional test case design.
- Positive and negative testing.
- Boundary value testing.
- Integration testing.
- Security testing.
- Performance testing.
- Failure and recovery testing.
- Regression testing.

For example, a fund-transfer test should verify successful transfer, insufficient balance, invalid account details, transaction limits, duplicate requests, network interruption, and rollback behavior.

Every defect should be documented and retested after correction. Regression tests should ensure that fixes do not introduce new problems.

Structured testing improves coverage, repeatability, traceability, and defect detection. As a result, transaction reliability increases and the risk of financial errors reaching customers is reduced.

26. Question

A system shows failures due to missing edge case testing. The testers focused only on normal inputs. Apply testing principles to include edge cases. Explain how boundary testing improves defect detection.

Answer

Testing only normal inputs is insufficient because many defects occur at boundaries and unusual conditions.

The testers should use **Boundary Value Analysis** along with negative testing and equivalence partitioning.

For example, if an application accepts a password length from 8 to 20 characters, test:

- 7 characters.
- 8 characters.
- 9 characters.
- 19 characters.
- 20 characters.
- 21 characters.

Additional edge cases should include empty input, maximum-size input, special characters, invalid formats, and unexpected values.

Boundary testing is effective because developers may incorrectly implement conditions such as `<` instead of `<=`

Including edge cases improves coverage and exposes defects that normal-value testing may miss. Therefore, systematic boundary and negative testing should be part of the standard test strategy.

27. Question

A development team struggles to maintain consistency in testing across modules. This leads to uneven quality. Apply process-based testing approaches to address this issue. Explain how standardization improves outcomes.

Answer

A **process-based testing approach** establishes common procedures, standards, templates, and quality criteria for all modules.

The organization should standardize:

- Test planning.
- Test case formats.
- Test execution procedures.
- Defect reporting.
- Severity and priority definitions.
- Entry and exit criteria.
- Regression testing.
- Test documentation.

For example, every module can use the same test case format containing test ID, requirement ID, preconditions, test steps, input data, expected result, actual result, and status.

Common standards ensure that different testers follow the same quality process. This improves consistency, traceability, test coverage, and communication.

Standardization does not mean every module receives identical tests; instead, the process remains consistent while the actual test scenarios are adapted to the module's risks and requirements.

28. Question

A web application fails due to improper handling of unexpected inputs. The testing team missed validation scenarios. Apply testing concepts to improve input validation. Explain how proper testing ensures robustness.

Answer

The testing team should strengthen **input validation testing** by testing both expected and unexpected inputs.

Test scenarios should include:

- Valid inputs.
- Invalid inputs.
- Empty values.
- Null values.
- Boundary values.
- Incorrect formats.
- Very large inputs.
- Special characters.
- Duplicate values.
- Unexpected data types.

For example, if a registration form requires a valid phone number, testers should verify valid numbers as well as letters, missing digits, empty values, special characters, and excessively long inputs.

Equivalence partitioning can divide inputs into valid and invalid classes, while boundary testing can focus on limits.

Proper validation testing ensures that unexpected inputs do not cause crashes, incorrect processing, or inconsistent outputs. It therefore improves application robustness and reliability.

29. Question

A software company faces frequent defect leakage into production. The management wants to reduce such issues. Apply testing principles to analyze the root cause. Explain how improved testing practices prevent leakage.

Answer

Defect leakage occurs when defects are not detected during testing and reach the production environment.

The root causes may include:

- Incomplete test coverage.
- Poor requirement understanding.
- Insufficient negative testing.
- Missing integration testing.
- Weak regression testing.
- Inadequate test environments.
- Poor defect analysis.
- Insufficient testing of edge cases.

The organization should analyze production defects and add corresponding scenarios to the regression suite.

For example, if a payment defect reaches production because duplicate transactions were not tested, a dedicated duplicate-transaction test should be added to future regression testing.

Other improvements include risk-based testing, requirement traceability, automation, code reviews, exploratory testing, and defect root-cause analysis.

These practices increase coverage and reduce the probability of critical defects escaping into production.

30. Question

A project team is unable to identify defects early due to poor testing strategies. This increases overall cost and effort. Apply testing principles to redesign the strategy. Explain how early defect detection improves efficiency.

Answer

The team should redesign testing around the principle of **early defect detection**. Testing should begin during requirements and continue throughout the SDLC.

The improved strategy should include:

1. Requirement reviews.
2. Early test planning.
3. Static analysis and reviews.
4. Unit testing.
5. Integration testing.
6. System testing.
7. Regression testing.
8. Continuous defect tracking.
9. Root-cause analysis.

For example, if an incorrect business rule is identified during requirement review, correcting the requirement is much cheaper than discovering the same issue after coding, system testing, or deployment.

Early detection reduces:

- Rework.
- Development cost.
- Testing effort.
- Production failures.
- Maintenance effort.

It also improves software quality because defects are prevented from propagating to later stages.

Therefore, a structured testing strategy with early involvement, systematic test design, and continuous validation provides better quality at lower overall cost.